

Draft - expert review pending

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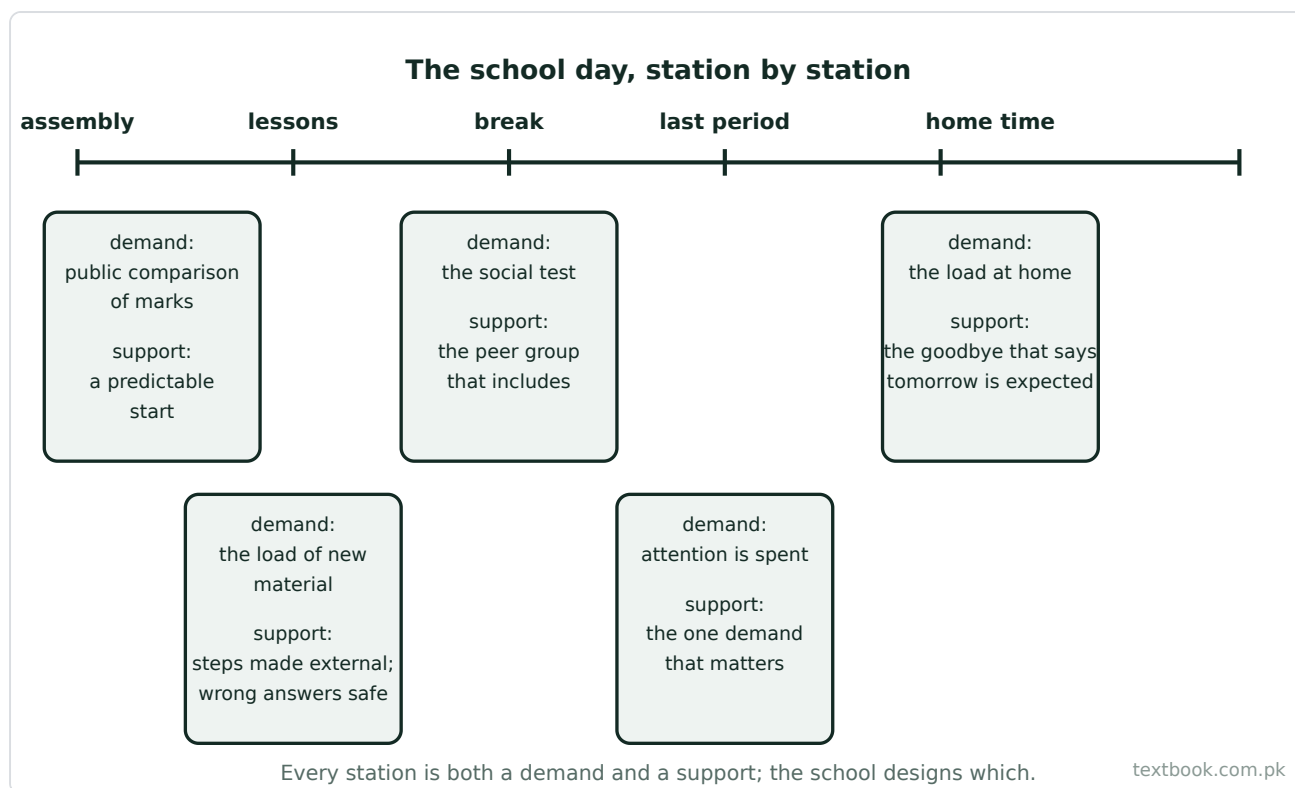
Draft translation - not yet human-reviewed / مسوده ترجمه

Topic 11.2 - The school's and the teacher's role in well-being

A real classroom situation

A Class 8 tutor in Hyderabad keeps a private map of her form: which pupils went quiet after the floods, which one's marks fell when his father's shop closed, which one has stopped eating at break. She does nothing dramatic. She greets each pupil by name at the door, keeps the morning routine unbroken, and asks one quiet question a week - "how is the week going?" - of the two pupils she is watching.

In March, one of them tells her something she cannot carry alone. She writes down what was said, word for word, and walks it to the head teacher the same hour. That sentence - written, dated, handed over - is the most professional act of her year, and it took four minutes.



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Explanation

The school environment and well-being: demands and supports

Topic 11.1 drew the balance; this topic walks it through the day. Every station of a school day is simultaneously a demand and a support, and **the school designs which it becomes**.

Assembly demands public standing and delivers public comparison; it can also be the day's predictable start - the routine that Unit 8 built, which is a well-being support wearing a timetable. **Lessons** demand new material at pace; they can also be the place where steps are made external (Unit 4) and wrong answers are safe (Unit 8's norm) - the two practices that most reduce classroom fear. **Break** is the social test; the peer group that includes (Unit 2's seating map, Unit 7's inclusion) is the support that meets it. **The last period** meets spent attention (Unit 4's depletion); the support is the one-demand rule. **Home time** carries the home load out of the school's sight; the support is the goodbye that says tomorrow is expected.

Reading the day this way converts the vague duty "we must support well-being" into an auditable list: which stations currently work as demands without supports, and what would flip them. The audit costs one walk of the timetable and repays it in the same coin as Unit 8's room audit.

The teacher's role and its limits: notice, respond, refer

The teacher's role in well-being has exactly three parts, and the third is where the profession lives.

Notice. The signs of Topic 11.1, read as patterns, kept in a private map. The map is not surveillance; it is attention with a memory - the difference between "he seems off today" and "this is the third Monday running".

Respond within the classroom. The moves are the course's own, now seen as well-being machinery: greet by name (the relationship that exists before it is needed, Unit 8); keep the routine unbroken (the predictability that fear cannot survive without); reduce the demand you control (the extension, the smaller list); name feelings calmly ("nerves mean it matters", Unit 6); and keep the pupil included by role (Unit 7's deliberate inclusion). None of these is therapy. All of them are protective, and every one is inside the teaching role.

Refer beyond it. The line is exact: the teacher escalates to the head teacher or the designated person - with the words written down, dated, and handed over the same day - when the signs exceed the classroom's reach: any talk of self-harm; a sudden calm in visible distress; a pattern that deepens despite the classroom supports; or anything the teacher cannot keep safe. The referral is not a failure of care; it IS the care, delivered by the right hands. And the boundary protects the pupil twice over: a teacher who counsels beyond training can do harm no kindness repairs, and a pupil who confides in a teacher who then keeps the confidence is left carrying it alone.

the teacher's move	what it supports	its limit
greet by name	belonging; the relationship before it is needed	it cannot reach what happens at home
keep the routine unbroken	predictability that fear cannot survive without	it does not remove the demand itself
reduce the demand you control	a load that fits the workbench	it cannot change the examination culture alone
name feelings calmly	the workbench returned; the emotion respected	naming is not treating
refer the same day, words written	the pupil carried by the right hands	the teacher's part ends at the handover - that is the profession, not a failure

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The misconception to clear now. "Referring is giving up on the pupil."

The reverse is true: the teacher who keeps a confidence that should have been escalated has chosen their own comfort over the pupil's safety, and the pupil pays. The tutor's four-minute walk to the head teacher - the sentence written, dated, handed over - is not the end of her care for that pupil; it is the moment her care became effective. What ends at the handover is the teacher's RESPONSIBILITY for treatment, never the relationship: the greeting, the routine and the quiet question continue, and they matter more after a referral than before it.

Activity: The walk of the timetable

In small groups, about 20 minutes.

Take one school you all know and walk its day, station by station: assembly, lessons, break, the last period, home time. For each station, write the demand as the pupils experience it and the support as it currently stands - including "none", where that is the truth.

Then, together: choose the **one station whose flip would protect the most pupils**, and design the flip - specific, cheap, and inside one teacher's or one school's power this term.

Check your understanding

1. Explain how one station of the day can be both a demand and a support, with an example. (*Understand*)
2. Name the teacher's role in three parts. (*Remember*)
3. Name any four classroom responses and the unit each came from. (*Remember*)
4. When does the classroom's reach end? Name any three triggers for the same-day referral. (*Understand*)
5. Why does the boundary protect the pupil twice over? (*Analyze*)

Summary

Every station of the school day is both a demand and a support, and the school designs which: the audit is one walk of the timetable. The teacher's role in well-being has three parts - notice (the signs read as patterns, kept in a private map), respond within the classroom (the course's own moves, now seen as well-being machinery), and refer beyond it (the words written, dated, handed over the same day, when the signs exceed the classroom's reach). The boundary protects the pupil twice: from a teacher counselling beyond training, and from a confidence that leaves them carrying it alone. What ends at the handover is the responsibility for treatment, never the relationship.

Self-assessment checklist

Sign in to sync your ticks across devices.

- ☐ I can walk a school day and name each station's demand and support.
- ☐ I can state the role's three parts and the moves of the middle one.
- ☐ I can name the same-day referral triggers.
- ☐ I can explain why the referral is the care, not the giving up.

Try this at your practicum school

Start the private map: one page, one form, the pupils you are quietly watching and the one thing you noticed about each this week. Keep it private, keep it factual, and keep the quiet question going. The map is the notice part of the role, and it is entirely yours.

Summative task

Write **250-300 words** on the four-minute walk.

The tutor's pupil disclosed something she could not carry alone. Write what she did next as a plan: what she wrote down and why the words matter, who she walked it to, what she said to the pupil before she went, and what she did NOT do. Close with what continues after the handover - and why that continuation is the profession's point.

Mini-rubric

Criterion	What a strong answer shows
The record is understood	Why verbatim, dated, written - not a summary from memory.
The pupil is prepared, not ambushed	What was said before the walk, and why it was said. (<i>Analyze</i>)
The not-do list is exact	No diagnosing, no promising secrecy, no carrying it alone.
Plain, accurate writing	Terms used correctly; no padding; within the word count.

Further reading

- World Health Organization. (2026). *Mental health: Strengthening our response* (fact sheet). <https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/mental-health-strengthening-our-response>
- Seifert, K., & Sutton, R. (2009). *Educational Psychology* (2nd ed.), Chapter 8. University of Manitoba. CC BY.
<https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/educational-psychology>

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